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# Miner Coach Says 'Cats 'As Strong' Cohen Calls ASU 'Powerhouse'

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Is the top-ranked University of Arizona baseball team stronger this season than defending Western Athletic Conference champion Arizona State?

Andy Cohen may be able to venture an educated guess Saturday. The veteran Texas-El Paso baseball coach brings his Miner squad to Tucson for a three-game series with the Wildcats.

The two teams play a single game Friday at 3 p.m. on Wildcat Field. A 1 p.m. doubleheader Saturday on the UA campus closes the series.

UTEP hosted the Sun Devils last weekend in the opening of

the WAC Southern Division race and Cohen's Miners managed to win the Friday opener 7-5 before dropping both games of a Saturday twin bill by scores of 36-10 and 11-5.

Cohen said Wednesday it would be a bad mistake to judge the Sun Devils by their 27-18 record.

"I think they've got a powerhouse," Cohen said. "Our win was a great boost in our morale but they blew us out of the park the next day. They've got a good ball club and I'm not going by their record.

"I mean, our record isn't so bad (21-11) but we haven't played some of the top teams in the nation. We played Oklahoma and they beat us 21-1 one day."

Cohen is in his 12th year as head coach of the Miner baseball program. He graduated from El Paso High and then lettered in three sports at the University of Alabama before breaking into professional baseball in 1925 as a player with Waco in the Texas League. What followed was almost 50 years of solid experience in baseball as a player, a coach and a manager.

In 11 seasons at UTEP the Miners have compiled a 197-225 record on a shoe-string budget and help from Andy's brother, Syd.

Cohen said that even though he has not seen Arizona he knows the Wildcats are as strong as the Sun Devils.

"We feel Arizona is as tough if not tougher than Arizona State," Cohen said. "I know Jerry Kindall (UA coach) real well and I have great respect for him. I know he's gone out and got himself some good ball players. I respect their pitching staff very, very much. They're going to be just as tough to play against as Arizona State."

Cohen said the chief problem with the Miners this season has been lackluster pitching with the exception of right-hander Roy Stringer.

In the Miners' win over ASU, Stringer went all the way and boosted his record to 5-0 for the year. He will start

Friday's game against the Wildcats.

"Pitching is the key as far as I'm concerned in any game we're going to play," Cohen said. "We have boys who have been able to score all year. But pitching has been very inconsistent outside of Stringer."

"Our boys have hit pretty well. My left fielder Von Hagen has been doing a bang-up job but he got hit on the elbow by a pitched ball the other day and I don't know if he'll be able to play by Friday. I feel bad because he's a great hustler."

The Miners play a doubleheader in El Paso today against McNeese State before traveling to Tucson tonight.